

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

had chores to do and allowances that provided them with ample spending money. Later they both worked summer jobs for additional spending money to buy extras like records, tapes, and designer clothes. Their parents provided them with the use of the family cars in high school and later bought them cars of their own.

Without realizing it, Don and Ann's parents were acclimating them to a lifestyle they couldn't maintain on their own. Like most young couples, they tried to duplicate what their parents had, and more. At first they rented an apartment, but in less than six months they decided that apartment living was not for them. Their decision to move was cemented when a couple of young single guys moved into the apartment next to them, hung six-foot speakers on the wall between their apartments, and played loud music all night. Pretty soon they said, "We can't stand this apartment. We need a home." So they went looking for a house.

Don and Ann made a common mistake that many young couples make. They looked at four-bedroom, two-bath houses first. Once they saw them, they knew they could never be satisfied with a two-bedroom, one-bath home. They realized that the house they wanted was out of their price range, but the less expensive homes were in less desirable neighborhoods. At the same time, both sets of parents realized that they couldn't let the kids get stuck with run-down housing, so they encouraged them to look in the "better" areas.

With this kind of parental guidance, they just knew God was telling them to "trust" Him. They couldn't qualify to buy a home because they didn't have the down payment. So one parent loaned them \$10,000 for the down payment on a \$90,000 home. They tried to finance an \$80,000 mortgage, but couldn't qualify for that either, so the builder, a friend of the family, agreed to carry a second mortgage for \$15,000. With their mortgage down to \$65,000, they finally qualified. It only took about 60 percent of their TOTAL income to pay the payments, interest, and taxes.

Each month they struggled to make the mortgage pay-